Global CO_2 Emissions

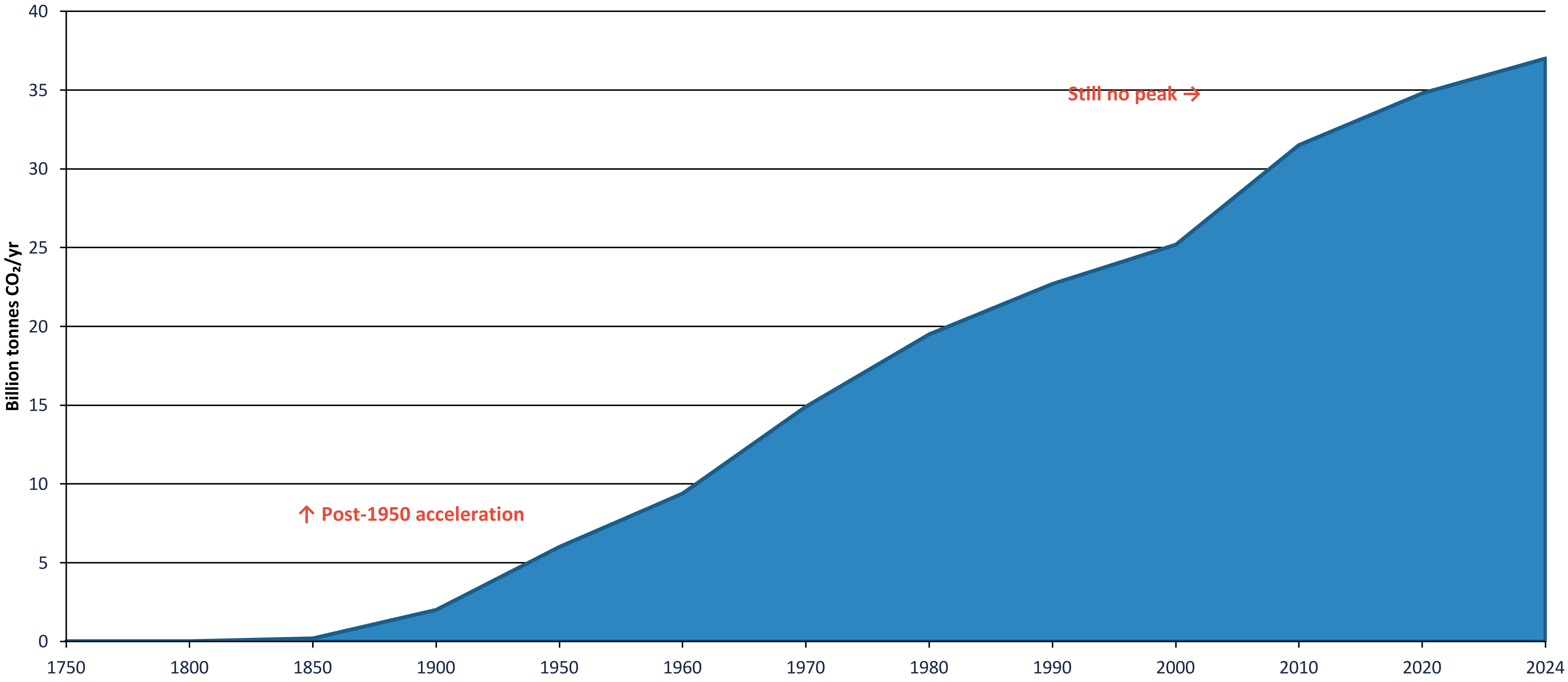
Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Fossil fuels & industry | 1750–2024

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

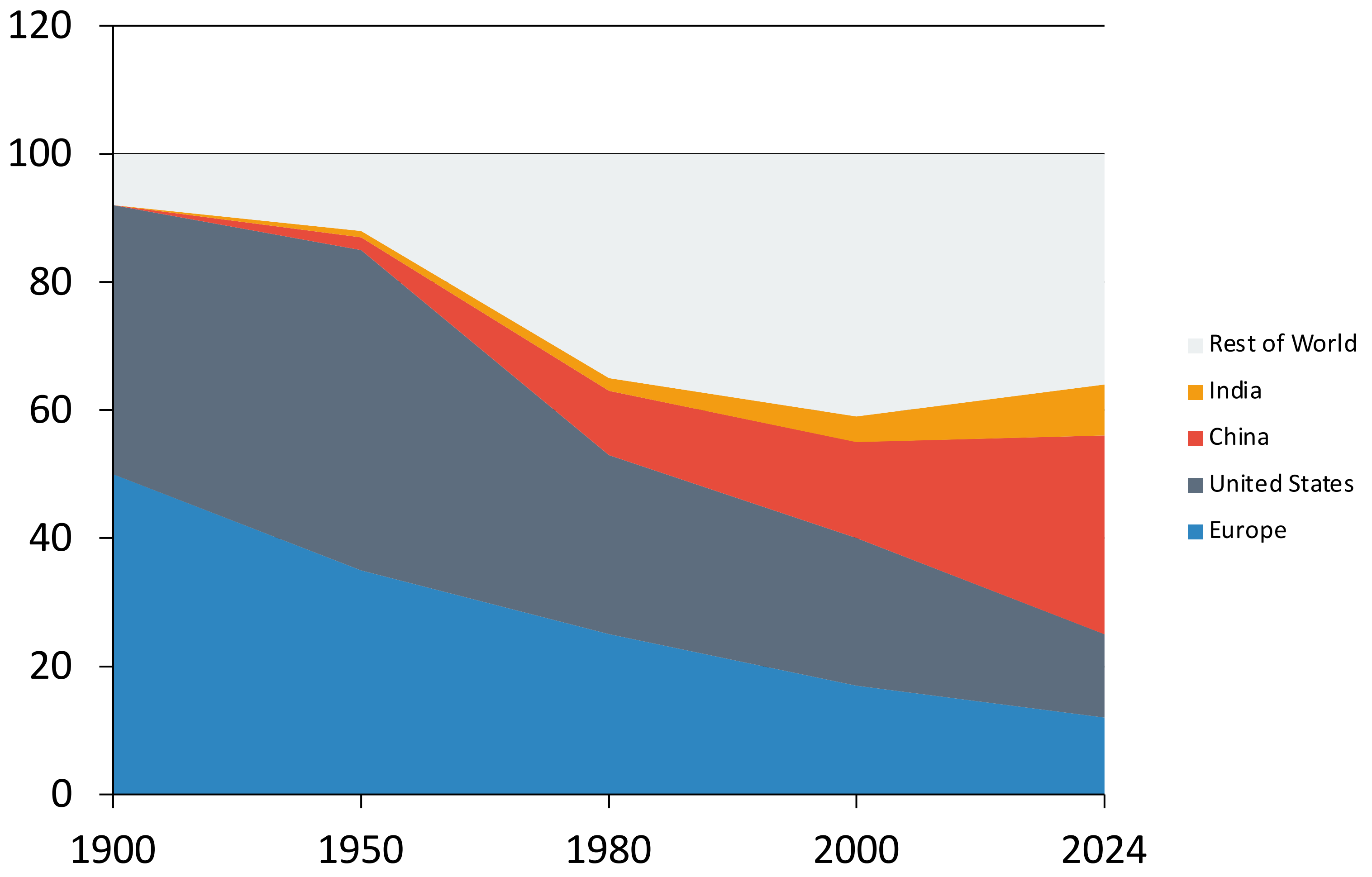
For policy analysts, climate negotiators & sustainability researchers

Global CO_2 Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today

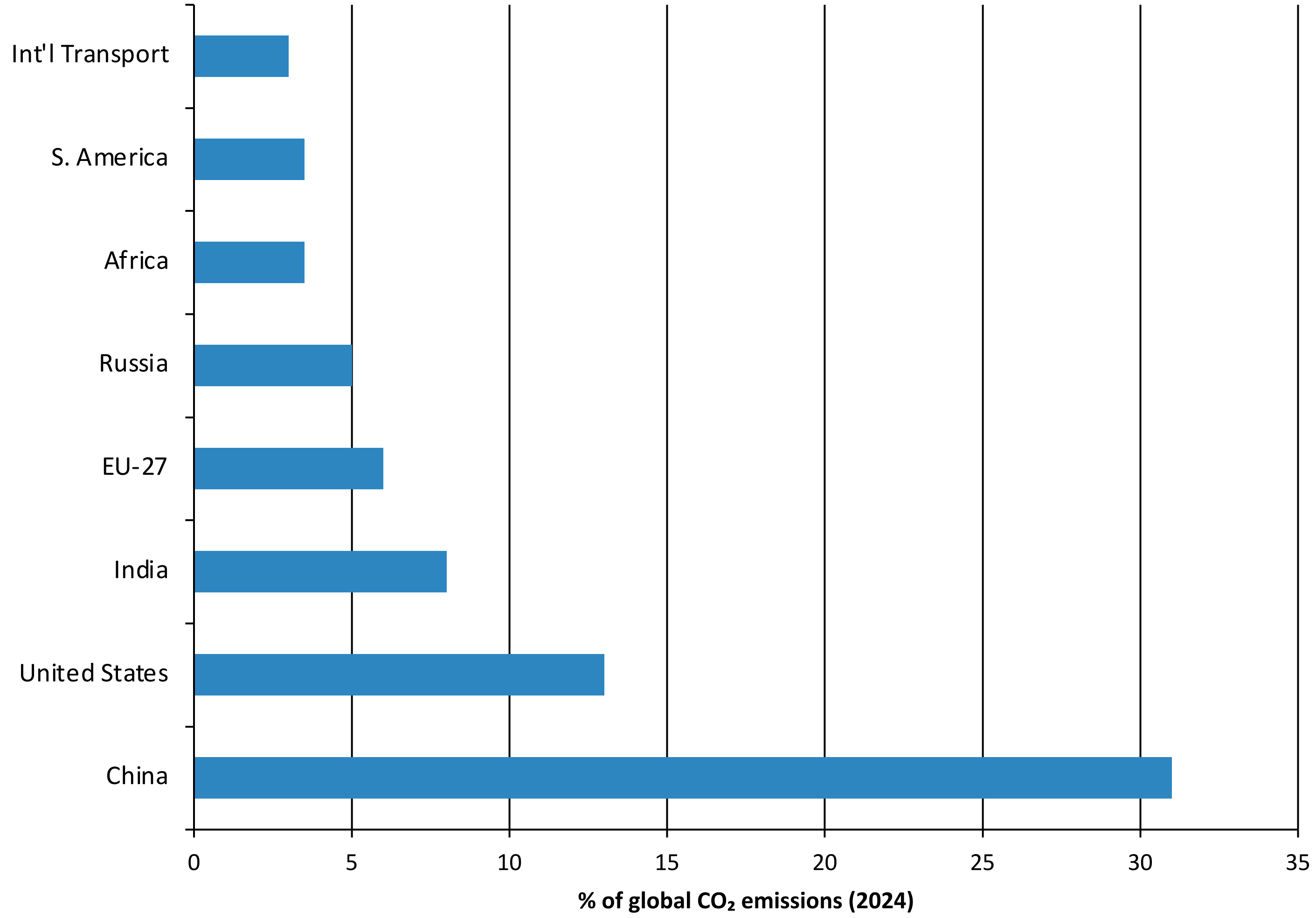


In 1900, Europe and the US accounted for >90% of global CO_2.

Today, they represent <⅓. Asia — led by China — now produces roughly half.

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO_2



China (~31%) emits more than the US and EU combined (~19%).

Africa and South America each emit only 3–4% — comparable to international aviation & shipping.

China: Rising, growth slowing

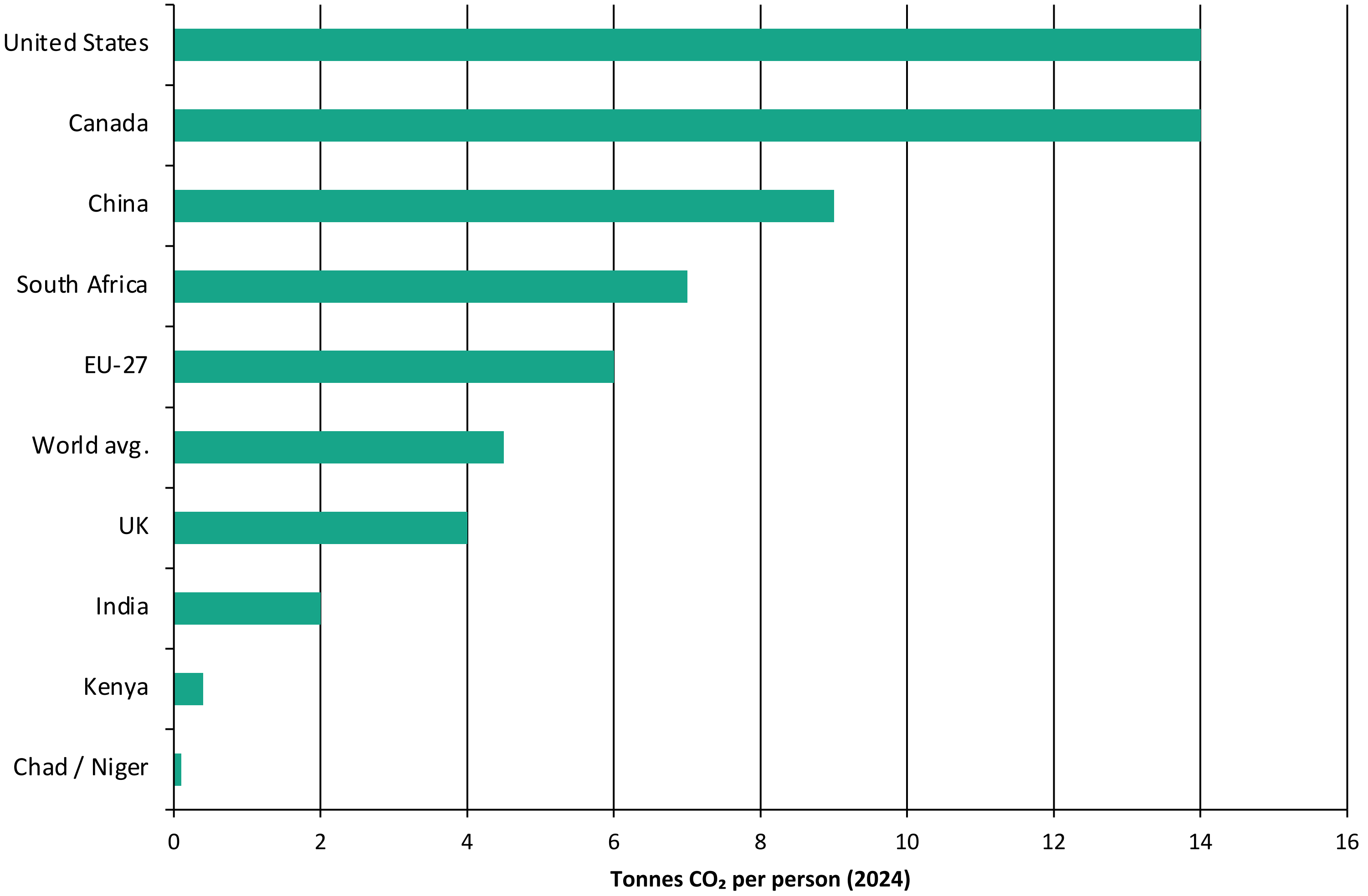
US: Declining

India: Rising

EU-27: Declining

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada

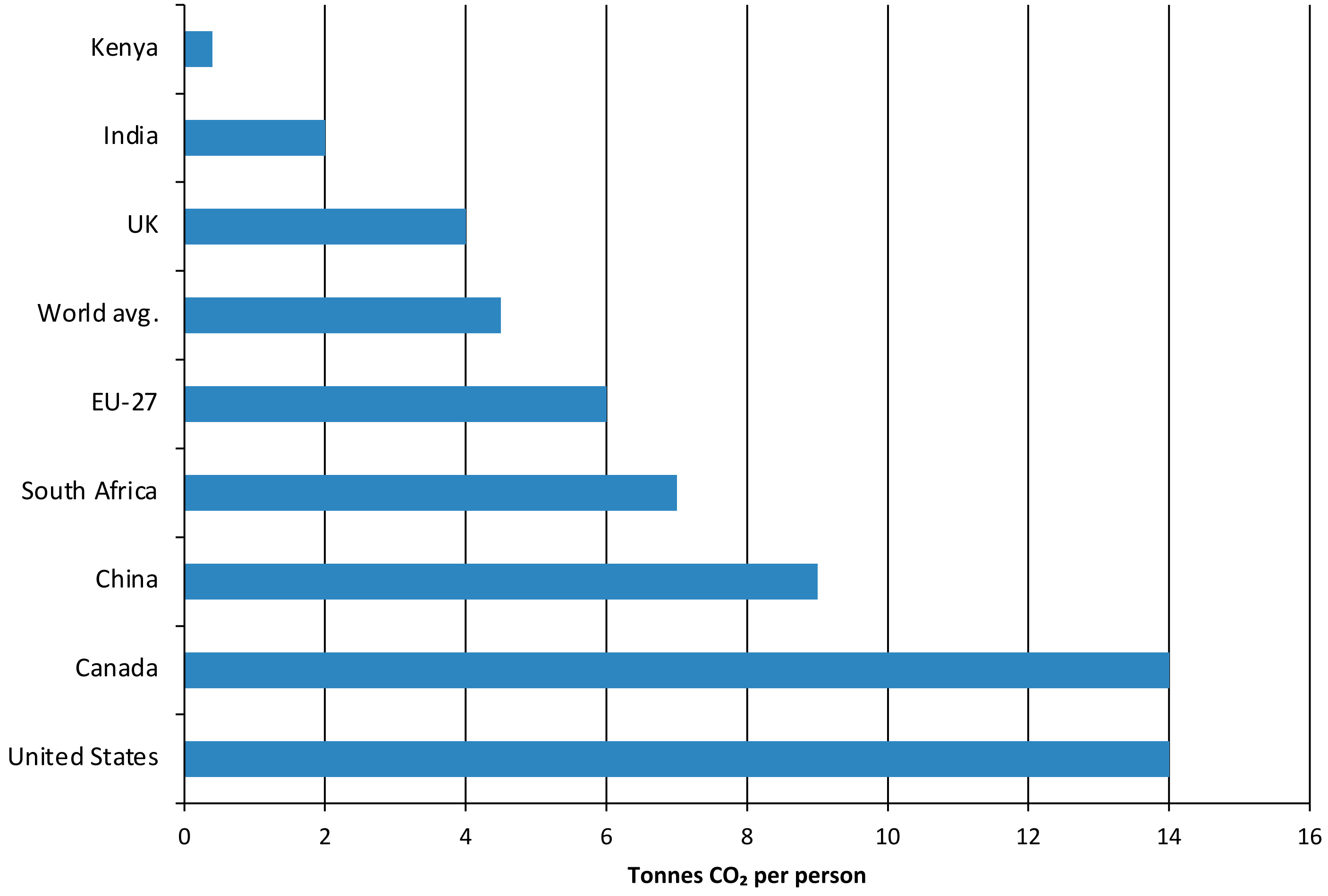


150× gap

The average American emits in under 2 days what a person in Chad emits in a year.

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Per Capita: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India



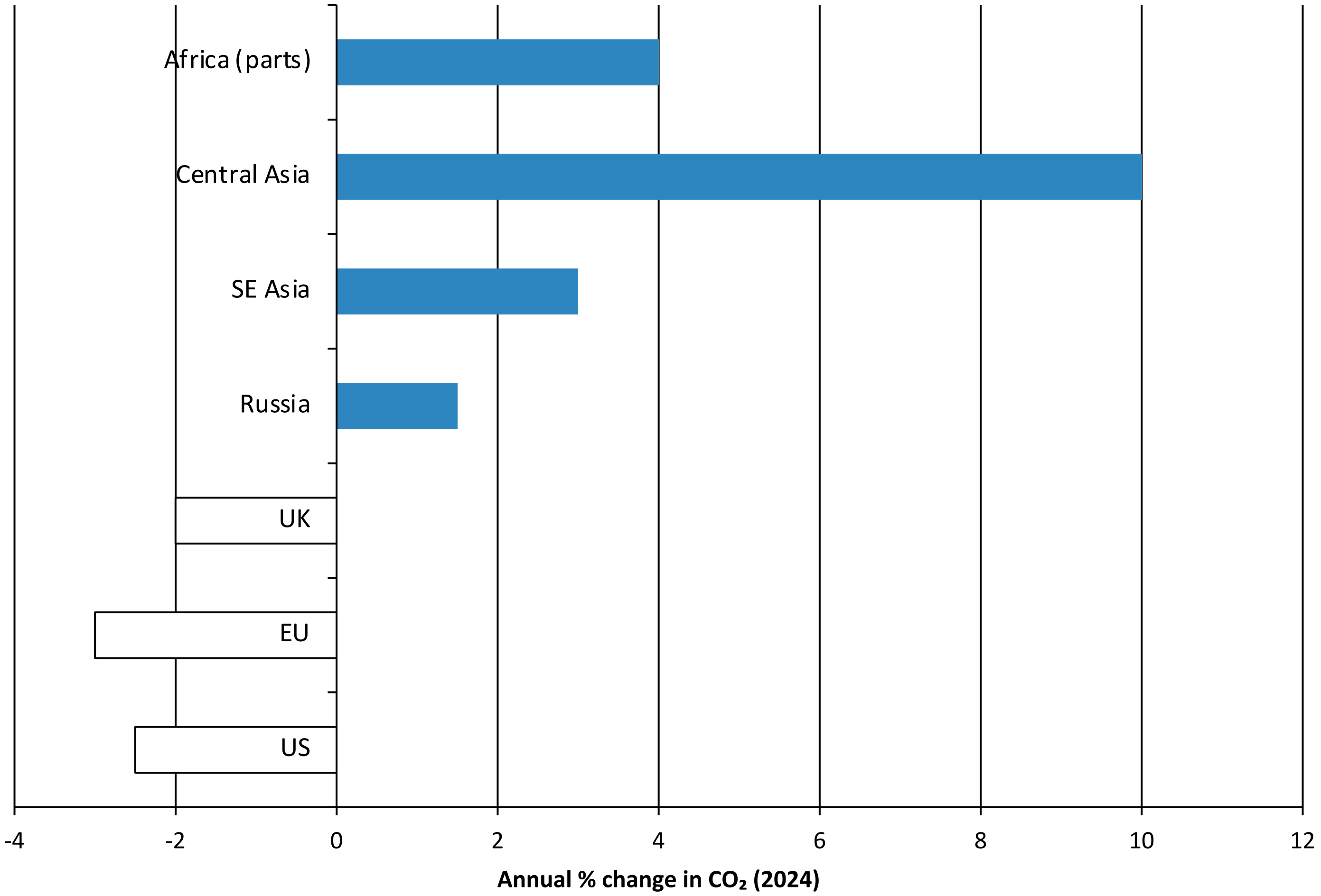
China is the world's largest total emitter, but its per capita emissions (~9 t) remain below the US (~14 t).

India's per capita emissions (~2 t) are less than half the world average (~4.5 t).

See figure_8.jpg for historical per capita trends.

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

2024: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions; Parts of Asia and Africa Grew



Declines (blue): US, EU, UK saw meaningful reductions.

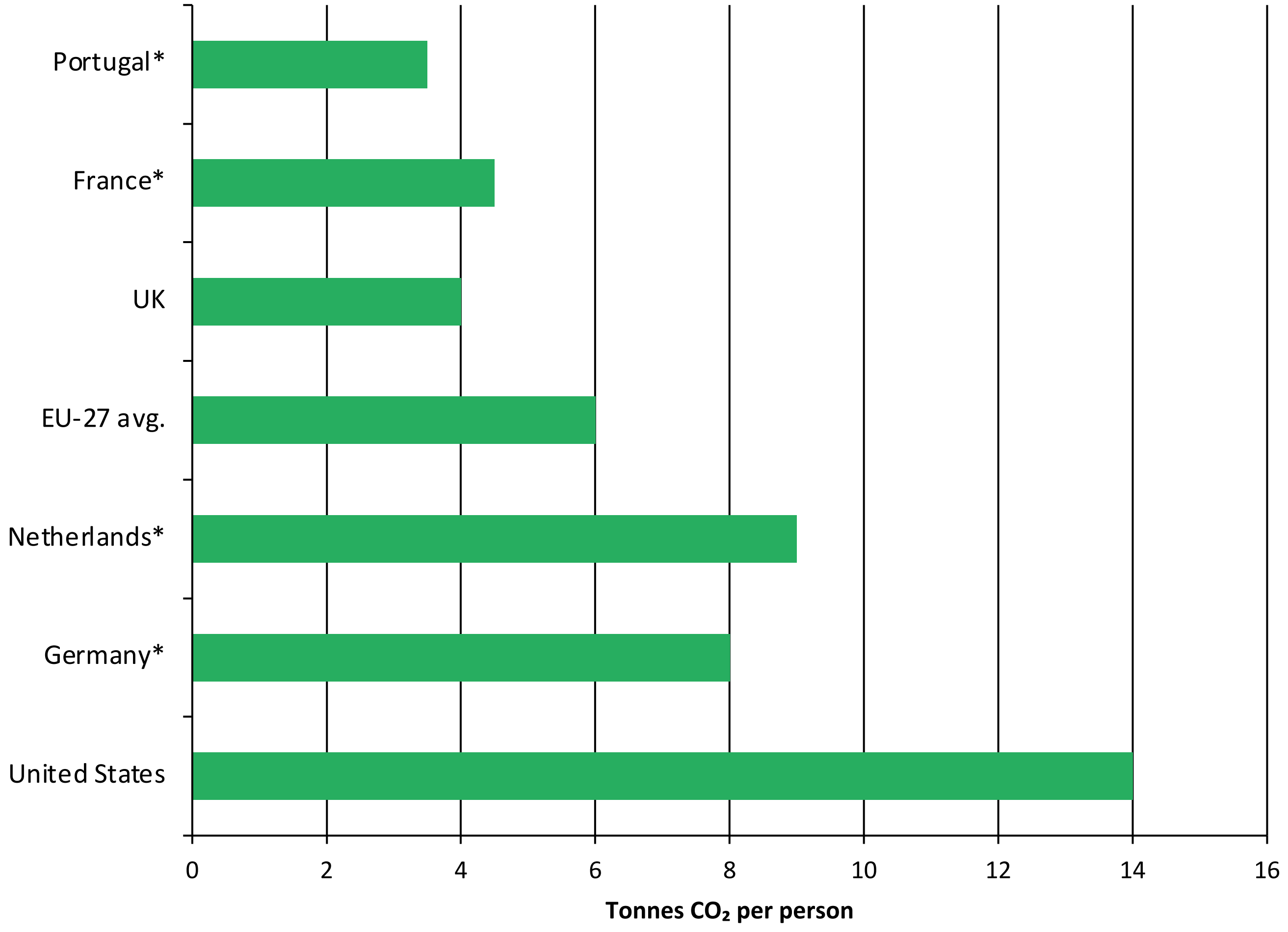
Increases (orange/red): Russia, SE Asia, parts of Africa grew.

Central Asia (e.g., Turkmenistan/Uzbekistan) saw increases exceeding 10%.

Net effect: global emissions continued to rise slightly.

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Energy Mix Explains Why France & UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or US



Among wealthy nations with similar prosperity, per capita emissions vary significantly:

• France, UK, Portugal: lower emissions thanks to higher shares of nuclear and renewable electricity

• Germany, Netherlands, US: higher emissions due to greater reliance on fossil fuels

Energy policy choices — not just wealth — drive these differences.

* Approximate / illustrative values for countries without exact figures in source data.

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

1. **No peak yet**
   Global emissions exceed 35 Bt/yr and continue to rise, despite slowing growth.

2. **China leads total emissions**
   ~31% of global CO_2 — but per capita (~9 t) still below the US (~14 t).

3. **Historical responsibility**
   Europe and the US dominated emissions for over a century (>90% in 1900).

4. **150× per capita gap**
   Sub-Saharan Africa (~0.1 t/person) vs. US/Canada/Australia (~14 t/person).

5. **Energy policy matters**
   Countries with similar prosperity can have very different emissions depending on energy mix.

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data